

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Nvidia reported** a nearly 80% rise in sales for its latest quarter that showed spending on its chips continues to soar despite jitters about the outlook for the AI boom. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed, with the Nasdaq and S&P 500 rising 0.3% and less than 0.1%, respectively, and the Dow falling 0.4%. **B10**
- ◆ **Eli Lilly plans to** build four new manufacturing plants in the U.S., a \$27 billion investment the company expects will create 3,000 high-skilled jobs and employ 10,000 construction workers. **B1**
- ◆ **BP said it would boost** oil-and-gas production and sharply cut investments in clean energy, pivoting back to fossil fuels in a bid to revive its flagging share price. **B1**
- ◆ **Stellantis expects to** return to profitable growth and positive cash generation this year, but investors were disappointed by the automaker's guidance. **B1**
- ◆ **Anheuser-Busch InBev's** shares rose after the brewer reported earnings that beat analysts' expectations, boosted by higher prices and improvements in the U.S. **B3**
- ◆ **Lowe's beat** Wall Street's views for sales and earnings after the home-improvement market reached an inflection point in the latest quarter. **B3**
- ◆ **Activist investor** Trian plans to push Solventum to further simplify its business after the company's \$4.1 billion deal to sell its filtration unit. **B3**
- ◆ **TJX expects demand** to keep rising this year after a strong quarter for customer transactions as its chains largely resist weak retail trends. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump said he revoked** a Biden-era license to produce oil in Venezuela, responding to what he said was strongman Nicolás Maduro's failure to assist in deporting migrants from the U.S. **A1**
- ◆ **Kyiv and Washington** are expected to sign a framework deal over mineral resources Friday whose most contentious element—military support to Ukraine—is yet to be negotiated. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump officials asked** federal agencies to plan for a significant reduction in staffing, cuts that would swell layoffs of government employees already made or threatened. **A4**
- ◆ **Chief Justice Roberts** temporarily halted a judge's requirement that the Trump administration resume nearly \$2 billion in foreign-aid payments, hours before the deadline. **A3**
- ◆ **Hamas handed over** what it said were the last four dead hostages included in the first phase of a cease-fire with Israel, mediators said, as they race to extend the truce. **A7**
- ◆ **An unvaccinated child** who tested positive for measles died in West Texas, the state health department said, amid a wider outbreak. **A3**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** concluded that Trump's pardons of Jan. 6 defendants should extend to separate conduct uncovered in searches stemming from the Capitol attack. **A3**
- ◆ **Iran sharply increased** its stockpile of highly enriched uranium in recent weeks as Tehran amasses a critical raw material for nuclear weapons. **A7**
- ◆ **Died: Michelle** Trachtenberg, 39, millennial-era screen star. **A6**

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Musk Gets Thumbs-Up at Cabinet Meeting



ACCORD: President Trump defended Elon Musk, standing in back, at a cabinet meeting Wednesday and raised the possibility that federal workers who didn't respond to an email from Musk asking what they accomplished last week could be fired. **A4**

The Trump 'Special' Staffers Who Get Paid by Private Clients

Katie Miller, a top aide to Elon Musk at the Department of Government Efficiency, spends much of her time on White House grounds, helping Musk

By Josh Dawsey, C. Ryan Barber and Katherine Long

plan and communicate his efforts to slash the federal government. But she also spends time working for P2 Public Affairs, a major Republican consulting

firm in Washington, which pays her full salary. She has continued to work for Fortune 100 clients, including Apple, offering public relations advice, according to people familiar with the matter. Since starting at the White House, Miller has also helped P2's leaders pitch the firm to new clients for lucrative contracts. Her husband is White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller, among the most powerful advisers in the administration, controlling all domestic policy.

She's one of a set of influential Trump employees who are working for the administration while simultaneously doing private-sector work. They carry a three-letter designation that allows them to wear both hats: "SGE," or special government employee. It's a status under federal ethics laws that permits private-sector employees to work inside the government without having to relinquish their outside salaries or investments. Only a sliver of cases must publicly disclose clients or potential conflicts of interest. While the rules limit work to up to 130 days in any given year, it can be extended if the administration desires. Others with the status include Steve Witkoff, who is handling peace talks between Ukraine and Russia and in the Middle East, Corey Lewandowski, now a top aide at the Department of Homeland Security, and Musk himself. Top officials such as Musk, Miller and Witkoff aren't receiving government salaries. *Please turn to page A10*

Ukraine Minerals Pact Has Unresolved Issues

KYIV, Ukraine—Both the U.S. and Ukraine touted a proposed deal over mineral resources as important, but the most contentious element—military support to Ukraine—and other details have yet to be negotiated.

By Jane Lytvynenko, Ian Lovett and Alan Cullison

President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine said on Wednesday that the success of the proposed deal depends on his broader conversations with President Trump and Trump's commitment to helping Ukraine. "This agreement can have a major success or quietly pass

by," said Zelensky, signaling that the proposed framework required more work. "And I believe that a major success depends on our conversation with President Trump." Trump said in his first cabinet meeting Wednesday that he expected the Ukrainian president to come to Washington on Friday to sign the agreement, which he said would share Ukraine's mineral resources. Earlier in the day, Zelensky said he wasn't sure if he would go. The financial benefits of the deal are still unclear. *Please turn to page A8*

- ◆ **Extracting Ukraine's minerals will be hard.....** **A8**
- ◆ **Leaders perfect art of the whisper.....** **A8**



THE FUTURE OF EVERYTHING

ROBOTS GET TO WORK POWERED BY AI R1-10

U.S. Hits Venezuela By Pulling Chevron License for Drilling

By KEJAL VYAS

President Trump said Wednesday he was revoking a Biden-era license allowing Chevron to produce oil in Venezuela over what he said was strongman Nicolás Maduro's failure to assist in deporting migrants. The move is a reversal of the Trump administration's monthlong rapprochement with Maduro and appears to be a setback for Chevron, the U.S. oil company that former President Joe Biden granted an exception to U.S. sanctions to pump in Venezuela in

2022. Trump didn't mention Chevron but said on social media that he was canceling a Nov. 26, 2022, license, the same time the company got its concession. Trump said Chevron's license will be terminated as of March 1, requiring the company to wind down its Venezuelan operations within months. Trump's announcement came nearly a month after senior White House envoy Richard Grenell met with Maduro in Caracas to strike a deal that would restart deportation flights to the country, a pact *Please turn to page A8*

Trump Day? GOP Bills Push Tributes

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Loyalists want to turn adulation into law

By KATY STECH FERREK AND XAVIER MARTINEZ

WASHINGTON—Congress didn't make George Washington's birthday a federal holiday until 80 years after his death. The Lincoln Memorial was dedicated nearly three score after the Gettysburg Address. Ronald Reagan had been out of office for almost a decade when Congress named National Airport for him. President Trump's most ardent supporters don't plan to wait for the commemorations to start. A Florida GOP lawmaker wants Trump's face chiseled into the memorial. *Please turn to page A10*

An Innocent Download Upends Worker's Life

By ROBERT MCMILLAN AND SARAH KROUSE

The stranger messaging Matthew Van Andel online last July knew a lot about him—including details about his lunch with co-workers at Disney from a few days earlier. His mind raced; he knew no one outside Disney would have access to that information. How did the person messaging him on chat forum Discord know what he had said in a private workplace Slack channel? "I have gained access to certain sensitive information related to your personal and professional life," another Discord message said. Van Andel realized he had been hacked. The next morning, the lunchtime Slack exchange became one of more than 44 million Disney messages from the workplace collaboration tool published online by a cryptic hacking group with

murky motivations. The hacker had used Van Andel's login credentials to steal from his employer. The hack sent Disney's cybersecurity team in motion to assess the damage. Private customer information, employee passport numbers, and theme park and streaming revenue numbers were in the huge data dump. The breach upended Van Andel's life. The hacker stole his credit-card numbers and racked up bills—and leaked his account login details, including those to financial accounts. The attacker published Van Andel's personal information online, ranging from his Social Security number to login credentials that could be used to access Ring cameras within his home. "It's impossible to convey the sense of violation," said Van Andel, a 42-year-old father of two boys. *Please turn to page A6*

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